

The Lighthouse at Saltmarsh

The lighthouse at Saltmarsh was built in 1884 by a mason named Oswin Hartley, who carried every stone from the quarry on a flat wooden cart. For forty winters the lamp was tended by the keeper Marguerite Dunmore, who recorded the weather in a blue ledger.

Ships passing the headland could see the beam for twelve miles, and the harbour master praised its steady light.

The Blue Ledger

The blue ledger survives in the village archive. Its last entry, dated 3 November 1923, reads that the fog bell rang for nine hours and that three fishing boats found the harbour safely.

After the keeper retired the lamp was automated, and the keeper's cottage became a small museum open on summer weekends.